

LocalSM Recruitment & Assessment Policy

Combined Round 1 + Round 2 Paper Format

This policy applies to all LocalSM recruitment assessments conducted in paper form, whether the company uses a single combined paper or two labeled sections within the same paper. Round 1 is the basic screening section; Round 2 is the technical assessment section. LocalSM may change the format, sequence, difficulty, time limit, scoring, or instructions for any role or hiring cycle at its sole discretion.

1. Acceptance of Policy

By registering for, accessing, signing, attempting, or submitting any LocalSM recruitment assessment, the candidate acknowledges that this policy has been read, understood, and accepted. Participation is voluntary, but compliance is mandatory. If a candidate does not agree to these terms, the candidate must not take the assessment.

2. Structure of the Assessment

LocalSM may use either of the following structures, depending on the role:

- A single paper containing both Round 1 and Round 2 as separate sections; or
- Two separate rounds conducted on the same day or on different dates.

Round 1 is a basic screening section intended to test fundamentals, clarity of thought, communication, and immediate role fit. Round 2 is a deeper assessment intended to test engineering judgment, architecture, reasoning, security awareness, product thinking, and problem solving under constraints.

The same paper format shall not be treated as a universal template for all roles. LocalSM may use a different paper, different scoring rules, or different question types for different positions or recruitment cycles.

3. Candidate Duties

- Work independently and honestly.
- Follow every instruction exactly as written.
- Write your name, email, date, and signature only in the designated fields.
- Submit only your own original work.
- Explain any written answer when asked.
- Maintain professional conduct throughout the process.

Candidates are responsible for ensuring that their answers are legible, complete, and submitted within the permitted time. Any answer that is unreadable, contradictory, copied, or unsupported by the candidate's own explanation may be treated as unreliable.

4. Prohibited Conduct

Unless LocalSM has expressly allowed it in writing for that specific assessment, the following are prohibited:

- Using AI tools, internet search, notes, books, messaging apps, or any external assistance.
- Communicating with another person during the assessment.
- Copying answers from another candidate, the internet, books, AI, or any prepared material.
- Using multiple devices, hidden devices, secondary browsers, or unauthorized storage media.
- Attempting to photograph, record, transcribe, reproduce, or redistribute the paper or any part of it.
- Impersonation, false identity, proxy attendance, or any attempt to take the assessment on behalf of someone else.
- Tampering with the assessment environment, evidence, proctoring, or submission process.

This list is illustrative, not exhaustive. Any conduct that LocalSM reasonably considers to compromise integrity, fairness, confidentiality, or authenticity may be treated as misconduct.

5. Monitoring and Verification

To protect assessment integrity, LocalSM may use reasonable verification measures, including identity checks, invigilation, webcam monitoring where remote, screen observation where applicable, timestamped submission logs, answer-sheet review, and follow-up technical questioning.

Candidates consent to such monitoring to the extent required for the assessment and permitted by applicable law. LocalSM may retain monitoring outputs, submissions, and review notes for recruitment integrity, dispute handling, and security purposes for as long as reasonably necessary and lawful.

6. Evidence, Review, and Final Determination

If LocalSM suspects a violation, it may review the paper, proctoring records, timestamps, metadata, answer consistency, identity evidence, and any other relevant material. LocalSM may also conduct a verification interview or require a re-explanation of any answer.

If LocalSM reasonably concludes that misconduct occurred, the candidate may be disqualified immediately without further rounds. LocalSM is not required to disclose every internal detection method, model, rule, or reviewer note.

7. Consequences of Misconduct

- Immediate termination of the assessment.
- Disqualification from the current recruitment cycle.
- Cancellation of any pending interview or assessment round.
- Internal marking of the application as failed for integrity reasons.
- Possible rejection of future applications where permitted by law and company policy.
- Referral to appropriate authorities where the facts indicate fraud, impersonation, theft, unauthorized access, or other reportable misconduct.

LocalSM may choose the severity of the response based on the nature of the conduct, the amount of assistance involved, whether the conduct was intentional, and whether the integrity of the entire assessment has been affected.

8. Confidentiality and Intellectual Property

All question papers, scenarios, datasets, scoring rubrics, answer keys, instructions, proctoring methods, and evaluation materials are confidential and remain the property of LocalSM.

- Candidates must not share the paper or any part of it with anyone.

- Candidates must not upload the paper to social media, websites, or AI tools.
- Candidates must not use the paper to train, fine-tune, or prompt any model.
- Candidates must not reproduce the paper in whole or in part.

Unauthorized disclosure may result in disqualification and other remedies available under applicable law.

9. Data Use, Privacy, and Retention

LocalSM will collect and use only the information reasonably required for recruitment, assessment administration, fraud prevention, and internal verification. This may include the candidate's name, contact details, assessment responses, timestamps, submission history, and integrity-related notes.

Where a candidate has rights under applicable law, including rights relating to access, correction, erasure, grievance, and withdrawal of consent, LocalSM will handle those requests in accordance with law and subject to any lawful retention or verification obligation.

LocalSM will not retain recruitment data longer than necessary for the stated purpose, unless retention is required for legal compliance, dispute handling, audit, or security review.

10. Legal Basis and Applicable Indian Law

This policy is designed to operate consistently with Indian law and should be read together with the recruitment notice, assessment instructions, and any candidate consent or acknowledgement displayed on the platform.

Law / Instrument	Relevant clauses	Why it matters here
Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023	Sections 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 11, 12, 13, 15, 16, 17	Covers lawful processing, notice, consent, security, rights, grievances, data retention, and exemptions.
Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025	Notified by MeitY on 14 Nov 2025; apply as and when the relevant rules are in force	Supports operational privacy, notice, and compliance handling for digital personal data.
Information Technology Act, 2000	Sections 4, 5, 43A, 66C, 66D, 67C	Recognizes electronic records and signatures, supports reasonable security practices, and addresses identity theft and cheating by personation.
Indian Contract Act, 1872	Sections 10, 13, 14, 19, 23	Supports acceptance of terms, consent, free consent, and lawful object/consideration.

The above list is non-exhaustive. LocalSM should obtain a lawyer review before publishing this policy, especially if it uses webcam monitoring, biometric checks, image capture, data retention rules, or any third-party proctoring vendor.

11. Candidate Declaration

By signing or submitting the assessment, the candidate declares that: (a) the work is original; (b) no unauthorized help was used; (c) the candidate understood the rules; (d) LocalSM may verify the submission; and (e) a confirmed violation may lead to immediate disqualification.

12. LocalSM Rights

- Change the format, duration, or evaluation method without prior notice.
- Reject any submission where authenticity cannot be reasonably verified.
- Require a re-test, re-explanation, or follow-up interview.
- Invalidate a result obtained through misconduct.
- Keep internal records of confirmed integrity violations.
- Decline future applications where permitted by law.

Nothing in this policy creates a right to selection, a right to employment, or a right to appeal.